Chapter 3: Democratic Governance & Civic Institutions

Class 6 - Social Science | Unit: Social and Political Life - I (Civics)

CHAPTER OVERVIEW & CORE FOUNDATIONAL CONCEPTS

Introduces the necessity of rules, institutional authority, levels of government, and fundamental democratic ideals.

KEY LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Define government and identify its three tiers: local (Panchayat/Municipality), state, and national.
2. Contrast democratic systems with monarchies and authoritarian regimes.
3. Understand Universal Adult Suffrage and equal voting rights regardless of wealth, gender, or caste.

1. LEVELS OF GOVERNMENT & RULE OF LAW

The government makes laws for the entire nation and enforces compliance. Laws ensure peaceful coexistence, fair commerce, and safety. In India, governance operates at three tiers: local, state, and central national level.

2. DEMOCRATIC PARTICIPATION & EQUALITY

In a democracy, ultimate sovereignty rests with the citizens who elect representatives through free, regular elections based on Universal Adult Franchise: one person, one vote, one value.

DIAGNOSTIC FOCUS & COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students often confuse the distinct operational jurisdictions of municipal councils (local roads, sanitation) with state governments (police, state education) and national bodies (defense, foreign affairs).

PREREQUISITE REINFORCEMENT QUESTIONS

Q1: What does Universal Adult Suffrage mean in Indian democracy?

Expected Answer: It means that all adult citizens aged 18 and above have the right to vote equally in elections, regardless of wealth, caste, religion, or gender.

Q2: Name the three tiers of government functioning in India.

Expected Answer: 1. Local government (Panchayat / Municipality), 2. State government, 3. National / Central government.